Puppet Studio v5

User Manual | Compact, Fixed Canvas Edition

This version is a standalone HTML animation editor. Open the HTML file in a modern desktop browser such as Chrome or Edge. It contains embedded character artwork, so it does not need separate asset files.

1. Workspace navigation

Control	Action
Minus (-)	Zoom out of the workspace canvas. The percentage decreases.
Plus (+)	Zoom into the workspace canvas. The percentage increases.
Fit	Restore the fitted stage view (100%) and reset the workspace pan offset.
Pan button	Click once to enable Pan (highlighted). Drag the canvas to move around your workspace. Click again to disable.
Esc	Exit Pan mode.
Mouse wheel over canvas	Zoom the workspace view.
Middle mouse drag	Move the workspace viewport even while the Pan button is disabled.
Alt + drag over canvas	Move the animation camera, not the workspace.
Alt + mouse wheel	Zoom the animation camera, not the workspace.

Important: Workspace zoom and pan affect how you inspect the editor; they do not change video or PNG exports. Camera position and zoom affect the actual animation framing and exports.

2. Using Pan correctly

1. Click **Pan**; its highlighted state means it is active. 2. Place the pointer directly over the canvas artwork and hold the left mouse button. 3. Drag in any direction. 4. Release the mouse. 5. Click **Pan** again to return to pose/asset editing. Press **Esc** if needed. If the canvas moves out of view, click **Fit**.

3. Camera Inspector

Click **Camera** to display camera controls in the Inspector sidebar. Click Camera again to close them, or select a layer to return to asset settings. Change the camera X/Y position and zoom while watching the canvas. Use the camera keyframe control to animate changes over time. Camera settings may also provide framing, reset, and output dimension controls.

4. Image and background alignment

Select an image or background asset in the Layers panel. Use the six alignment icons in the Inspector: Left, Centre, Right, Top, Middle, Bottom. They align the selected asset to the stage bounds. Alignment changes an asset position; it is different from moving the viewport with Pan.

5. Sprite selection

Select the head or hand layer in Layers. Choose a sprite thumbnail in the Inspector to switch pose. With Auto-key enabled, choosing poses at different frames records discrete hold-keyframe changes. Existing parenting and rig connections remain attached.

6. Animation and keyframes

Select a layer and seek to a frame on the timeline. Use the Inspector controls to change a property. Auto-key records changes as keyframes. You can select one or more timeline keyframes and remove them using Delete/Backspace; the timeline also provides keyframe tools. Preview with Play and use motion presets to start simple movements such as waving or sitting. Adjust character poses as required.

7. Save, open, and export

Use **Save** to download the editable project file. Use **Open** to load a saved project. **Video** records animation using browser-supported recording formats. **PNG zip** exports image frames. Saving the project file is recommended before testing large animation changes.

8. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Remedy
Cannot stop panning	Click Pan again or press Esc. Pan should lose its highlighted state.
Canvas off-screen	Click Fit to reset workspace zoom and pan.
Zoom buttons do not appear to affect exported footage	They change workspace view only. Use Camera zoom for exported framing.
Camera controls not showing	Click Camera and inspect the right sidebar. If another layer is selected, Camera mode is closed.
Clicking an asset does not pose it	Make sure Pan is disabled and select Pose or Move part as needed.
Video export unavailable	Try a current Chrome or Edge browser; export depends on MediaRecorder support.

9. Validation notes

Automated Chromium interaction checks passed for Plus, Minus, Fit, Pan drag, Pan enable/disable, Esc, Camera Inspector open/close, and no uncaught page errors during those checks. This does not certify every animation or export workflow across all devices and browsers.